

Week 3 troubleshooting

Walk the room with this page. Most failures are missing braces, forgotten `append` assign, nil maps, or flaky map-order tests.

What they see	Likely cause	What you do
non-boolean condition in <code>if</code>	<code>if score</code> with an int	<code>if score != 0</code> or compare properly
syntax error near <code>if</code>	parentheses from C/JS, or missing <code>{</code>	braces required; no <code>()</code> around cond
<code>i</code> declared and not used	ranged but ignored poorly	use <code>_</code> for unused index/value
slice length wrong after <code>append</code>	did not assign	<code>s = append(s, x)</code>
"append changed the other slice"	shared backing array	draw boxes; <code>copy / append([]T(nil), s...)</code> for independence
assignment to entry in nil map	wrote before <code>make</code>	<code>m = make(map[string]int)</code>
<code>go test</code> fails comparing maps as strings	relied on print order	check each key with comma-ok
Unique output shuffled	ranged a map for output	use <code>seen</code> map + <code>append</code> to slice in input order
<code>Contains</code> always false	compared wrong type / trimmed badly	print inputs; keep it simple equality
<code>go: cannot find main module</code>	no <code>go.mod</code>	<code>go mod init epiclearn/week03</code> in <code>slicekit</code>
<code>undefined: Contains</code> in test	different packages / unsaved file	both files <code>package slicekit</code>
infinite loop	<code>for {</code> without <code>break</code>	add exit condition
Windows PowerShell oddities	wrong terminal	stay in Ubuntu (WSL)

What they see	Likely cause	What you do
Binary on GitHub	<code>.gitignore</code> missing	ignore binaries; <code>git rm --cached</code>

`go test` ritual

```
cd ~/epic-go/week03/slicekit
go mod init epiclearn/week03 # once
go test
```

If they already have a `go.mod`, do not run `go mod init` again.

Nuclear rewrite

If a student's folder is a mess, clean `~/epic-go/week03` and retype demos. Do not paste the starter until they have tried the labs.